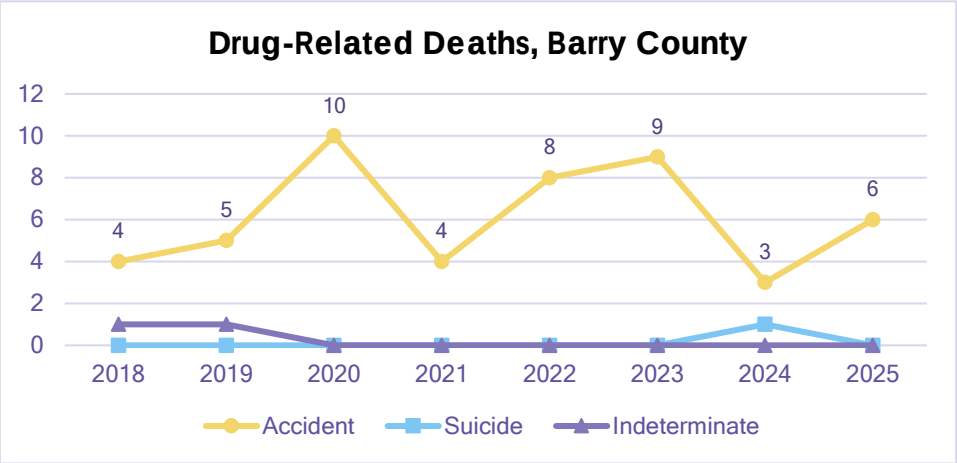
Drug-Related Deaths by Manner, Barry County[16]

	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Accident	4	5	10	4	8	9	3	6
Suicide	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Indeterminate	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total	**5**	**6**	**10**	**4**	**8**	**9**	**4**	**6**



Suicides by Age, Barry County

	Total	0 - 17	18 - 25	26 - 44	45 - 64	65 +
2016	**9**	1	0	1	5	2
2018	**9**	1	0	1	4	3
2019	**7**	1	1	0	3	2
2020	**7**	0	1	2	3	1
2021	**10**	1	1	1	3	4
2022	**11**	0	0	6	2	3
2023	**5**	0	2	1	2	0
2024	**8**	0	3	1	3	1
2025	**12**	0	3	2	2	5

[16] Acute alcohol intoxications are considered drug-related deaths and are included in this data

Suicides by Mechanism, Barry County

	2016	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Firearm	7	7	4	4	9	5	3	5	7
Hanging	1	1	3	2	1	3	1	2	4
Carbon Monoxide	0	0	0	1	0	2	1	0	0
Drug Intoxication	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
Motor Vehicle	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1
Sharp Force Trauma	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
Asphyxia/Suffocation	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total	**9**	**9**	**7**	**7**	**10**	**11**	**5**	**8**	**12**

Homicides by Mechanism, Barry County

	2025
Firearm	0
Blunt Force Trauma	0
Sharp Force Trauma	0
Motor Vehicle	0
Asphyxia/Suffocation	1
Other	0
Total	**1**

BERRIEN COUNTY

Summary of All Berrien County Cases

	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Total Deaths in the County	1,622	1,873	1,916	1,899	1,700	1,738[17]	1,792[18]
Deaths Reported to the ME	430	596	604	631	626	610	666
Deaths Investigated	399	540	548	563	520	525	561
MEI Scene Investigations	353	461	484	498	466	456	499
Death Certificates by ME	152	207	215	271	271	233	244
Bodies Transported to WMed	132	152	159	191	202	172	192
Complete Autopsy	90	103	116	138	130	105	108
Limited Autopsy	5	4	3	5	6	5	7
External Examination	26	25	26	32	49	43	56
Storage Only at WMed	11	20	14	16	17	19	19
Total Cases with Toxicology	110	126	134	156	165	137	147
Unidentified Remains After Exam	1	3	1	1	0	0	0
Referrals to Gift of Life	80	137	156	182	216	232	332
Tissue Donations	7	8	7	8	24	15	27
Cornea Donations	4	7	4	4	12	18	17
Unclaimed Investigations	10	19	17	18	15	18	19
Exhumations	1	0	2	0	0	0	0

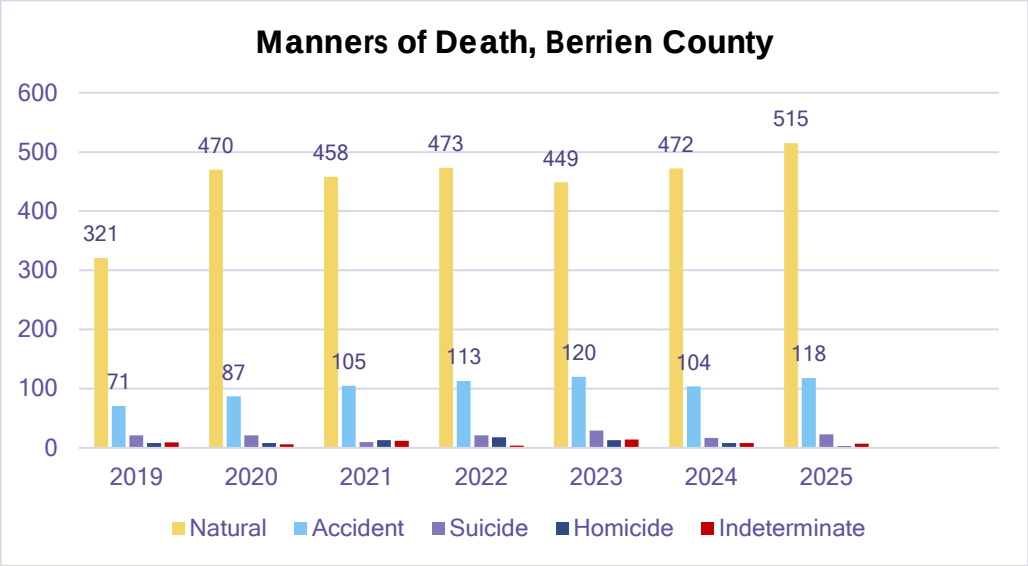
Cremation Permit Authorizations, Berrien County

	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Cremation Permits	1,045	1,218	1,219	1,263	1,193	1,207	1,299
% of Total Deaths with Cremation	64%	65%	64%	67%	70%	70%	72%

[17] Updated total number of deaths occurring in the county
[18] Provisional total number of deaths occurring in the county

Manners of Death Reported, Berrien County

	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Natural	321	470	458	473	449	472	515
Accident	71	87	105	113	120	104	118
Suicide	21	21	10	21	29	17	23
Homicide	8	8	13	18	13	8	3
Indeterminate	9	6	12	4	14	8	7[19]
Total	**430**	**592**	**598**	**629**	**625**	**609**	**666**



Deaths Reported by Age (in years), Berrien County[20]

	< 1	1 - 5	6 - 10	11 - 17	18 – 25	26 - 44	45 - 64	65 +
2019	6	1	1	2	6	58	108	246
2020	2	2	0	5	16	55	172	340
2021	5	0	0	4	12	60	152	367
2022	1	2	2	7	14	66	181	356
2023	9	2	1	5	10	66	165	367
2024	6	0	0	2	7	42	154	398
2025	3	1	0	4	15	43	168	430

[19] (1) Sudden unexplained death in an unsafe sleep environment, multiple respiratory viral pathogens presents; (1) Multiple potentially lethal comorbidities and context of substantiated caregiver neglect; (1) following a complete investigation, autopsy, and after conducting all appropriate studies, a cause of death cannot be determined; (1) Undetermined; (1) Possible unsafe sleep environment with blanket and stuffed animal in crib in setting of cerebral palsy and developmental delay with possible remote hypoxic-ischemic brain injury of unknown cause, possible acute respiratory viral infection; (1) Found deceased in pond in a state of decomposition; (1) Found unresponsive in potentially unsafe sleep situation

[20] All stillbirths and spontaneous abortions (miscarriages) investigated but not requiring an examination have been removed from this table for a more accurate representation of deaths reported under the age of one year

Pediatric Deaths, Berrien County

The eight deaths of individuals under 18 years of age include:

1. <1 year old
   a. (1) Unexpected sudden death associated with unsafe sleep; indeterminate
   b. (1) Unexpected sudden death associated with unsafe sleep and multiple respiratory viral pathogens present; indeterminate
   c. (1) Sequelae of osteogenesis imperfecta; natural
2. 1-5 years old
   a. (1) Unexplained sudden death associated with possible unsafe sleep environment in setting of cerebral palsy and developmental delay with possible remote hypoxic-ischemic brain injury of unknown cause, possible acute respiratory viral infection; indeterminate
3. 11-17 years old
   a. (2) Gunshot wound of head; suicide
   b. (2) Sudden unexpected death due to epilepsy; natural

Infant Deaths (Live Birth to 1 Year)	ME-Certified with Autopsy	ME-Certified without Autopsy	Total Certified by ME
2023	6	0	6
2024	5	0	5
2025	3	0	3

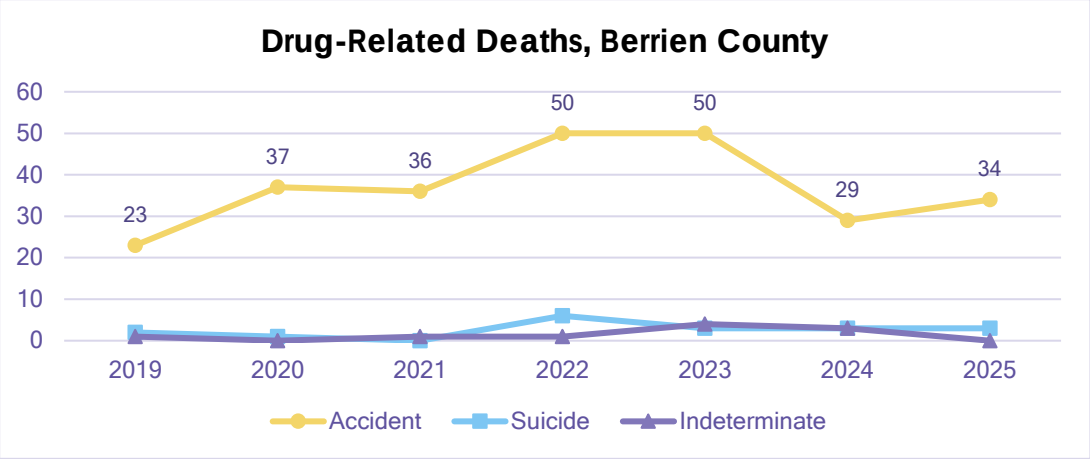
Accidental Deaths by Mechanism, Berrien County

	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Vehicle	21	15	24	9	16	18	24
Drug-Related	23	37	36	50	50	29	34
Drowning	4	9	3	5	6	3	5
Fall	12	15	34	39	38	37	44
Fire	2	2	1	0	4	1	0
Environmental Exposure	3	4	2	4	1	4	5
Asphyxia	3	4	3	2	3	8	1
Other	3	1	2	4	2	4	5[21]
Total	**71**	**87**	**105**	**113**	**120**	**104**	**118**

[21] (2) Asphyxia, choked on food bolus; (1) Sequelae of choking on food bolus, frontotemporal dementia; (1) Pulmonary saddle embolism, recent orthopedic surgery; (1) Anoxic brain injury, witness choking event

Drug-Related Deaths by Manner, Berrien County[22]

	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Accident	23	37	36	50	50	29	34
Suicide	2	1	0	6	3	3	3
Indeterminate	1	0	1	1	4	3	0
Total	**26**	**38**	**37**	**57**	**57**	**35**	**37**



Suicides by Age, Berrien County

	Total	0 - 17	18 - 25	26 - 44	45 - 64	65 +
2019	**21**	1	0	9	4	7
2020	**21**	1	2	4	8	6
2021	**10**	1	2	3	0	4
2022	**21**	1	1	6	10	3
2023	**29**	3	5	12	6	3
2024	**17**	1	2	4	6	4
2025	**23**	2	3	9	5	4

[22] Acute alcohol intoxications are considered drug-related deaths and are included in this data